

THE ULTIMATE KNITTING LIBRARY

Knits for Your Pets

60 Adorable Patterns for Dogs, Cats & More

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SECTION 1

Measuring Your Pet

How to take accurate measurements for perfectly fitting knitwear

A well-fitting garment is a safe garment. Before you cast on a single stitch, grab a soft tape measure and your pet's favourite treats.

Key Measurements for Dogs

You need four core measurements to size any dog garment. Always measure with your dog standing naturally on a flat surface.

- 1 Neck Circumference** — Wrap the tape around the base of the neck where a collar would sit. Add 2–3 cm of ease so the garment slips on comfortably.
- 2 Chest Girth** — Measure the widest part of the ribcage, just behind the front legs. This is the most critical measurement for sweaters.
- 3 Back Length** — From the base of the neck (where the collar sits) down the spine to the base of the tail. For sweaters that don't cover the full back, measure to your desired length.
- 4 Front Leg Length** — From the chest/armpit area to the desired sleeve end. Many patterns use short sleeves or none, so this is optional.

Key Measurements for Cats

Cats are measured the same way, but require extra ease because they are more flexible and less tolerant of snug fits.

- 1 Neck Circumference** — Around the base of the neck. Add 3–4 cm ease for cats (they need more room to wriggle).
- 2 Chest Girth** — Around the widest part of the ribcage. Add at least 3 cm ease.
- 3 Back Length** — From neck base to the base of the tail. Cat garments are usually shorter to allow freedom of movement.

Dog Size Chart

SIZE	NECK (CM)	CHEST (CM)	BACK LENGTH (CM)	TYPICAL BREEDS
XS	20–25	30–38	20–25	Chihuahua, Yorkie, Toy Poodle

SIZE	NECK (CM)	CHEST (CM)	BACK LENGTH (CM)	TYPICAL BREEDS
S	25–30	38–48	25–33	Pomeranian, Maltese, Shih Tzu
M	30–38	48–60	33–43	Cocker Spaniel, Beagle, Corgi
L	38–48	60–76	43–55	Labrador, Golden Retriever, Boxer
XL	48–56	76–96	55–70	German Shepherd, Great Dane, Mastiff

Cat Size Chart

SIZE	NECK (CM)	CHEST (CM)	BACK LENGTH (CM)	TYPICAL BREEDS
S	18–22	30–36	25–30	Siamese, Devon Rex, Sphynx
M	22–26	36–42	30–36	Domestic Shorthair, Abyssinian
L	26–30	42–50	36–42	Maine Coon, Ragdoll, British Shorthair

⚠ Safety First

Never leave your pet unsupervised in knitwear. Avoid buttons, toggles, or small decorative elements that could be chewed off and swallowed. Check all garments regularly for loose yarn or holes. If your pet shows signs of distress, remove the garment immediately.

Tips for a Perfect Fit

- Always knit a gauge swatch with your chosen yarn before starting.
- When in doubt, size up — a slightly loose garment is safer and more comfortable than a tight one.
- Try the garment on your pet during construction (at the armhole stage) to check fit.
- Use stretchy cast-on and bind-off methods for neck and leg openings.
- Consider belly straps with velcro instead of pull-over styles for pets that resist dressing.

SECTION 2

Dog Sweaters

15 patterns from beginner-friendly basics to show-stopping cables

Keep your pup warm and stylish with these sweaters designed for comfort, durability, and easy washing.

The Classic Ribbed

Beginner

Sizes: XS–XL • **Yarn:** Worsted weight • **Time:** 4–6 hours

A timeless 2×2 rib sweater that stretches to fit and looks neat on any breed. Knit flat in one piece, seamed at the belly. Great first pet project.

Cozy Cable Pullover

Intermediate

Sizes: S–XL • **Yarn:** Aran weight • **Time:** 8–12 hours

A centre cable panel flanked by reverse stockinette gives this sweater a classic handknit look. Knit in the round from the neck down with raglan shaping.

Hooded Pup Coat

Intermediate

Sizes: XS–L • **Yarn:** Bulky weight • **Time:** 8–10 hours

A cozy hooded sweater with a drawstring-free hood (safety first). The hood is picked up and knit from the neckline. Seed stitch border throughout.

Sporty Stripe Vest

Beginner

Sizes: XS–XL • **Yarn:** DK weight • **Time:** 3–5 hours

Bold horizontal stripes in stockinette stitch. No sleeves, so it's perfect for active dogs. Simple colour changes every 4 rows.

Fair Isle Turtleneck

Advanced

Sizes: S–L • **Yarn:** DK weight • **Time:** 12–16 hours

A traditional Fair Isle yoke with a fold-over turtleneck. Uses 3 colours in a snowflake-inspired motif. Knit in the round; chart included.

Garter Stitch Easy-On

Beginner

Sizes: XS–XL • **Yarn:** Worsted weight • **Time:** 3–4 hours

All garter stitch, knit flat as a rectangle with leg holes. Fastens under the belly with knitted ties. The easiest pattern in this book.

Aran Diamond Jumper

Advanced

Sizes: M–XL • **Yarn:** Aran weight • **Time:** 14–18 hours

Intricate diamond cable panels with moss stitch fill. A real show-piece for larger dogs. Knit flat in pieces and seamed. Full chart provided.

Chunky Raglan

Beginner

Sizes: S–XL • **Yarn:** Super bulky • **Time:** 2–3 hours

Super-fast knit in chunky yarn on large needles. Top-down raglan construction with minimal finishing. A weekend project.

Henley Button-Band

Intermediate

Sizes: XS–L • **Yarn:** DK weight • **Time:** 6–8 hours

A preppy henley-style neckline with a short button band (buttons sewn securely and backed with felt for safety). Stockinette body with ribbed trim.

Nordic Snowflake Coat

Advanced

Sizes: S–XL • **Yarn:** DK weight • **Time:** 14–18 hours

An all-over Nordic colourwork pattern with snowflakes and pine trees. Lined with a sewn-in fleece layer for extra warmth. Three-colour stranded knitting.

Waterproof-Lined Raincoat

Intermediate

Sizes: S–XL • **Yarn:** Worsted cotton blend • **Time:** 8–10 hours

Stockinette shell with a sewn-in waterproof lining. Velcro belly closure for easy on/off. Rolled hood stays back when not in use.

Basketweave Blanket Coat

Beginner

Sizes: M–XL • **Yarn:** Bulky weight • **Time:** 5–7 hours

Basketweave stitch creates a textured, thick fabric perfect for cold-weather walks. Simple construction, belly strap closure.

Lace-Trim Summer Tee

Intermediate

Sizes: XS–M • **Yarn:** Cotton DK • **Time:** 5–7 hours

A lightweight cotton tee for sun protection with a delicate lace border at the hem. Breathable openwork pattern on the back panel.

Varsity Letter Sweater

Intermediate

Sizes: S–L • **Yarn:** Worsted weight • **Time:** 8–10 hours

Intarsia letter on the back (alphabet chart included so you can knit your dog's initial). Contrast ribbed collar, cuffs, and hem.

Bobble Texture Pullover

Intermediate

Sizes: XS–L • **Yarn:** Aran weight • **Time:** 8–12 hours

Rows of bobbles alternating with stockinette create a playful, three-dimensional texture.

Top-down seamless construction.

SECTION 3

Cat Sweaters

5 cat-friendly designs with easy-on, easy-off construction

Cats are more sensitive to clothing than dogs. Every pattern here prioritises easy dressing, lightweight yarn, and freedom of movement.

⚠ A Note on Cats & Clothing

Not all cats tolerate wearing garments. Introduce knitwear gradually, starting with just a few minutes at a time. Hairless breeds (Sphynx, Devon Rex) benefit most from sweaters. Never force a garment on a cat that freezes, flattens, or shows signs of stress.

Sphynx Simple Wrap

Beginner

Sizes: S–L • **Yarn:** Baby-soft DK • **Time:** 3–4 hours

A simple wrap-around design that fastens with velcro under the belly. No pulling over the head. Extra-soft yarn to protect sensitive skin.

Step-In Vest

Beginner

Sizes: S–L • **Yarn:** Cotton DK • **Time:** 3–5 hours

The cat steps into the leg holes and the vest fastens at the back with a single button. No over-the-head stress. Lightweight cotton for indoor wear.

Kitty Cable Poncho

Intermediate

Sizes: S–M • **Yarn:** Worsted weight • **Time:** 5–7 hours

A poncho-style garment that drapes over the back and fastens at the chest. Central cable panel. Easy on and off without confining the legs.

Ribbed Turtleneck Mini

Beginner

Sizes: S–L • **Yarn:** Merino DK • **Time:** 4–6 hours

A stretchy 2×2 rib turtleneck that's snug but not restrictive. Wide neck opening for easy dressing. Short body length leaves the hind legs free.

Fair Isle Cat Coat

Advanced

Sizes: S–L • **Yarn:** Fingering weight • **Time:** 8–12 hours

A miniature Fair Isle coat with fish motifs. Double-layered colourwork keeps it warm. Velcro belly tabs for quick removal. Charted pattern included.

SECTION 4

Pet Bandanas

10 quick-knit bandanas for instant pet style

Bandanas are the perfect quick project — most take under two hours and use small amounts of yarn. Great for using up scraps.

Classic Triangle Tie-On

Beginner

Sizes: S, M, L • **Yarn:** DK cotton • **Time:** 1–2 hours

A simple triangle knit from the point up with increases. Long ties at the top to knot around the collar. Garter stitch throughout.

Collar-Slide Kerchief

Beginner

Sizes: S, M, L • **Yarn:** DK weight • **Time:** 1–2 hours

Features a knitted tube at the top that slides onto the existing collar. No tying required — just thread the collar through. Stockinette body.

Seed Stitch Scarf Bandana

Beginner

Sizes: One size (adjustable) • **Yarn:** Worsted weight • **Time:** 1–2 hours

A narrow scarf with a triangular point at the centre. Wraps around the neck and ties. Seed stitch gives it a lovely texture on both sides.

Striped Party Bandana

Beginner

Sizes: S, M, L • **Yarn:** DK weight (3 colours) • **Time:** 1.5–2 hours

Bold stripes in three contrasting colours. Tie-on style. Perfect for birthdays and celebrations. Simple colour changes.

Lace-Edge Fancy Kerchief

Intermediate

Sizes: S, M, L • **Yarn:** Cotton DK • **Time:** 2–3 hours

A delicate lace border along the bottom edge of a stockinette triangle. Collar-slide attachment. A touch of elegance for special occasions.

Textured Chevron

Intermediate

Sizes: S, M, L • **Yarn:** Worsted weight • **Time:** 2–3 hours

A chevron/zigzag pattern created with knit and purl stitches. Reversible texture. Tie-on style with i-cord ties.

Cable-Band Collar Wrap

Intermediate

Sizes: S, M, L • **Yarn:** Aran weight • **Time:** 2–3 hours

A narrow cable runs along the neckband with a hanging triangular point in stockinette. Button closure at the back of the neck.

Bobble-Trim Bandana

Intermediate

Sizes: S, M, L • **Yarn:** DK weight • **Time:** 2–3 hours

A row of small bobbles along the bottom edge adds a playful, three-dimensional finish. Garter stitch body. Tie-on style.

Double-Knit Reversible

Advanced

Sizes: S, M, L • **Yarn:** DK weight (2 colours) • **Time:** 3–4 hours

Double knitting creates a two-colour, two-sided bandana with a different colour on each face. Collar-slide style. Thick and warm.

Fringed Western

Beginner

Sizes: S, M, L • **Yarn:** Worsted cotton • **Time:** 1.5–2 hours

A garter stitch triangle with a fringe along the bottom edge made from cut yarn lengths. Tie-on style. Short fringe only (safety).

SECTION 5

Pet Beds & Blankets

10 patterns for cozy napping spots and warm covers

Knitted beds and blankets make wonderful gifts for pet owners — and your pet will love them even more than store-bought versions.

✓ Washability Tip

All bed and blanket patterns in this section are designed for machine-washable yarn. Use superwash wool or cotton blends. Wash on a gentle cycle in cold water and lay flat to dry for best results.

Chunky Nest Bed

Beginner

Sizes: S (45 cm), M (60 cm), L (75 cm) • **Yarn:** Super bulky • **Time:** 4–6 hours

A round, raised-edge bed knit in the round on large needles. Stuffed walls create a nest shape. Removable cushion insert for washing.

Garter Stitch Blanket

Beginner

Sizes: S (60×60 cm), L (90×90 cm) • **Yarn:** Worsted weight • **Time:** 8–12 hours

An all-garter-stitch blanket — the simplest pattern possible. Knit in one piece. Great for TV knitting. Squishy and reversible.

Cable-Panel Throw

Intermediate

Sizes: 70×90 cm • **Yarn:** Aran weight • **Time:** 16–20 hours

Three wide cable panels joined with reverse stockinette. A beautiful heirloom-quality blanket. Knit in strips and seamed.

Patchwork Squares Blanket

Beginner

Sizes: Customisable • **Yarn:** DK weight (scraps) • **Time:** 12–18 hours

Knit individual squares in different colours and stitch patterns, then seam them together. A perfect scrap-busting project. Each square is 15×15 cm.

Bolster Pillow Bed

Intermediate

Sizes: S (40 cm), M (55 cm) • **Yarn:** Bulky weight • **Time:** 6–8 hours

A rectangular bed with a bolster pillow along three sides. Knit flat in pieces and seamed. Polyfill stuffing. Zip-in base for washing.

Basketweave Pet Mat

Beginner

Sizes: 50×70 cm • **Yarn:** Worsted cotton • **Time:** 6–8 hours

A flat mat in basketweave stitch, ideal for placing inside a crate or carrier. Thick cotton yarn dries quickly after washing.

Hooded Cave Bed

Advanced

Sizes: S (40 cm), M (55 cm) • **Yarn:** Super bulky • **Time:** 10–14 hours

An enclosed cave-style bed that cats and small dogs love. Knit in the round with short-row shaping for the hood. Wire frame keeps shape.

Striped Fleece-Lined Blanket

Intermediate

Sizes: 75×100 cm • **Yarn:** DK weight • **Time:** 12–16 hours

A striped stockinette blanket backed with sewn-in fleece for extra warmth. The fleece lining also prevents stretching and snagging.

Round Cushion Cover

Intermediate

Sizes: 45 cm, 60 cm diameter • **Yarn:** Aran weight • **Time:** 5–7 hours

Two circular pieces knit from the centre out, joined around the edge. Fits a standard round cushion insert. Spiral rib texture.

Arm-Knit Giant Blanket

Beginner

Sizes: 80×100 cm • **Yarn:** Jumbo roving • **Time:** 1–2 hours

No needles required — knit with your arms using jumbo-weight roving. An incredibly fast project with dramatic results. Loose-knit, ultra cozy.

SECTION 6

Pet Toys

10 knitted toys your pets will love to chase, chew, and cuddle

Knitted toys are quick, fun, and let you use up leftover yarn. Each pattern includes safety guidance on stuffing and construction.

⚠ Toy Safety

Use polyester fiberfill only — never loose beans, rice, or plastic pellets that could spill out. Seam all toys tightly with a tapestry needle and double-check seams regularly. Remove any toy that shows signs of coming apart. Supervise play, especially with aggressive chewers. For cats, avoid yarn dangles longer than 15 cm.

Classic Knitted Ball

Beginner

Sizes: S (6 cm), M (9 cm), L (12 cm) • **Yarn:** Worsted cotton • **Time:** 1–2 hours

A simple sphere knit from increases and decreases. Stuff firmly with fiberfill. Add a jingle bell inside for extra fun (for cats; avoid for chewers).

Mouse Chase Toy

Beginner

Sizes: 8 cm body • **Yarn:** DK weight • **Time:** 1–1.5 hours

A tiny knitted mouse with a short knitted tail (no string). Embroidered eyes (no buttons). Stuffed with fiberfill and a pinch of catnip.

Knotted Bone

Beginner

Sizes: S (15 cm), L (25 cm) • **Yarn:** Worsted cotton • **Time:** 1.5–2 hours

A bone shape knit as a tube with stuffed bulges at each end. Triple-stitched seams for durability. Great for gentle fetch games.

Braided Tug Rope

Beginner

Sizes: 30 cm, 45 cm • **Yarn:** Bulky cotton • **Time:** 1–2 hours

Three knitted i-cords braided together and knotted at the ends. Durable cotton yarn stands up to tugging. No stuffing needed.

Fish Kicker

Beginner

Sizes: 20 cm • **Yarn:** DK weight • **Time:** 2–3 hours

A fish-shaped cat toy sized for bunny-kicking. Flat body with dorsal and tail fins. Filled with fiberfill and dried catnip. Embroidered details.

Squeaky Donut

Intermediate

Sizes: 12 cm diameter • **Yarn:** DK weight (2 colours) • **Time:** 2–3 hours

A donut shape with knitted “icing” in a contrast colour. Optional squeaker insert. Short i-cord “sprinkles” sewn on top. Adorable for photos.

Crinkle Cube

Beginner

Sizes: 8 cm cube • **Yarn:** Worsted weight • **Time:** 1.5–2 hours

A soft cube stuffed with fiberfill and a crinkly plastic bag insert (sealed in a fabric pouch). Cats love the crinkle sound. Six squares seamed.

Octopus Tentacle Toy

Intermediate

Sizes: 18 cm total • **Yarn:** DK weight • **Time:** 3–4 hours

A stuffed head with 8 short knitted tentacles (kept under 10 cm each for safety). Embroidered face. Each tentacle is an i-cord.

Tennis Ball Cozy

Beginner

Sizes: Standard tennis ball • **Yarn:** Worsted cotton • **Time:** 45 min–1 hour

A stretchy cover that fits over a standard tennis ball, adding texture and a new scent. Easy to remove for washing. Great for fetch.

Carrot Stick

Beginner

Sizes: 20 cm • **Yarn:** DK weight (orange + green) • **Time:** 1.5–2 hours

A carrot-shaped toy with green i-cord “leaves” at the top. Firmly stuffed. A fun, colourful toy for dogs and cats alike.

SECTION 7

Pet Accessories

10 fun and decorative accessories for pampered pets

From bow ties to food bowl mats, these quick-knit accessories add personality and charm to your pet's everyday life.

Knitted Bow Tie

Beginner

Sizes: S, M, L • **Yarn:** DK weight • **Time:** 30–45 min

A simple rectangular piece pinched in the centre and attached to a collar-slide band. Dapper for photos and special occasions.

Flower Collar Charm

Beginner

Sizes: One size • **Yarn:** DK weight • **Time:** 30–45 min

A layered knitted flower that slides onto any collar. Three petals in a contrast colour over a leaf base. Quick and charming.

Ribbed Collar Cover

Beginner

Sizes: S, M, L • **Yarn:** Cotton DK • **Time:** 1–2 hours

A tube of ribbed knitting that slides over an existing collar, giving it a softer, cosier look. Easily removed for washing.

Food Bowl Placemat

Beginner

Sizes: 30×45 cm • **Yarn:** Worsted cotton • **Time:** 3–4 hours

A thick, absorbent cotton mat to place under food and water bowls. Seed stitch for maximum absorbency. Machine washable.

Holiday Stocking

Intermediate

Sizes: 25 cm long • **Yarn:** Worsted weight (2 colours) • **Time:** 3–4 hours

A mini stocking for your pet's holiday treats. Striped cuff, heel turn, and a hanging loop. Knit their name in duplicate stitch.

Knitted Leash Sleeve

Beginner

Sizes: Standard leash handle • **Yarn:** Worsted cotton • **Time:** 1–2 hours

A tubular knitted sleeve that slides over a leash handle for a softer, more comfortable grip. Ribbed for stretch and grip.

Paw-Print Coasters (Set of 4)

Beginner

Sizes: 10 cm square • **Yarn:** Worsted cotton •
Time: 2–3 hours (set)

Four coasters with a paw-print motif in intarsia. Double-thick for absorbency. A sweet gift for any pet lover.

Treat Pouch

Intermediate

Sizes: 10×12 cm • **Yarn:** DK weight • **Time:** 2–3 hours

A small drawstring pouch for carrying treats on walks. Knit in the round with an eyelet row for the drawstring. Lined with fabric.

Cable Knit Leash

Advanced

Sizes: 120 cm • **Yarn:** Bulky cotton • **Time:** 6–8 hours

A fully knitted leash with a cable pattern, reinforced with an internal nylon cord for strength. Loop handle and metal clip attachment.

Pet Portrait Frame

Intermediate

Sizes: Fits 10×15 cm photo • **Yarn:** DK weight • **Time:** 2–3 hours

A knitted frame cover that wraps around a simple photo frame. Seed stitch border with knitted paw-print appliques at the corners.

Next Step

You now have **60 patterns** to spoil your furry, four-legged friends with handmade knitted love. Pick a project that matches your skill level, grab your needles and some cozy yarn, and start creating something special for your pet.

Remember: always prioritise safety, check the fit as you go, and enjoy watching your pet show off your handiwork. Happy knitting!